

Entrepreneurship

Building companies: product, validation, teams, operations, funding, and growth

- Level: All levels
- Format: Self-paced micro-lessons + exercises
- Estimated time: 6-10 hours
- Last update: 2025-12-26

Entrepreneurship turns ideas into systems that produce value and cashflow. This module teaches how to validate ideas, build products, structure teams, manage operations, and scale sustainably.

Rule: Build something people want, then build systems that deliver it reliably.

1. Learning Outcomes

By the end of this module, the learner will be able to:

- Validate a business idea using customer discovery
- Design a simple business model with unit economics
- Build an execution plan: team, operations, and KPIs
- Understand funding options and growth strategies

Prerequisites

- Willingness to talk to customers and learn
- Basic understanding of revenue and costs

2. Curriculum Map (Suggested Path)

Unit	Focus	Key Deliverable
1	Problem selection and customer discovery	Problem brief
2	Business model and unit economics	Business model canvas
3	MVP and validation experiments	MVP plan
4	Teams, operations, and KPIs	Operating dashboard
5	Scaling and funding	Growth roadmap

3. Core Concepts

Start with the problem

Strong businesses solve painful problems for a clear audience. Validate problem intensity before building.

Unit economics

Know your revenue per customer and cost to serve. If unit economics are negative, growth increases losses.

- Gross margin
- CAC vs LTV
- Payback period

MVP mindset

MVP is the smallest test that can validate demand. Build experiments, not perfect products.

Systems and execution

Operations make the business reliable: processes, roles, KPIs, and accountability.

4. Practical Toolkit

Use these templates and checklists while you learn. Keep them in your investor journal.

Customer Discovery Script

Learn what customers truly need.

- Ask about their current process
- Ask what is hard/expensive/frustrating
- Ask what they tried before
- Ask what would make them pay for a solution
- Ask for a small commitment (email, waitlist)

Business Model Canvas (Simplified)

See the business on one page.

- Customer segment
- Value proposition
- Channels
- Revenue streams
- Cost structure
- Key activities
- Key resources
- Key partners

Operating KPI Dashboard

Manage what matters weekly.

- Choose 3-5 KPIs (revenue, conversion, retention)
- Set weekly targets
- Review weekly with actions
- Assign owners per KPI

5. Hands-on Exercises

Validate a problem

Talk to real people and test demand.

- Interview 5 potential customers
- Write the top 3 repeated pains

- Write what they currently pay/time they waste
- Draft a value proposition

Output: Problem validation report

Build unit economics

Estimate profitability per customer.

- Estimate price and revenue per customer
- Estimate cost to acquire (CAC)
- Estimate cost to serve
- Compute gross margin and payback

Output: Unit economics table

Design a 90-day roadmap

Plan MVP, launch, and iteration.

- Define MVP scope
- Define 3 experiments
- Define weekly KPIs
- Define roles and responsibilities

Output: 90-day roadmap

6. Quick Assessment (Self-Check)

Answer in 5-10 minutes. If you miss more than 2 questions, review Units 1-3.

- 1. Why does problem selection matter more than idea creativity?
- 2. What is unit economics and why can growth be dangerous?
- 3. What is an MVP and what is it not?
- 4. Name three KPIs a startup might track weekly.
- 5. What is customer discovery?

7. Mini Glossary

MVP: Minimum viable product: smallest test of demand.

Unit economics: Profitability per customer unit.

Gross margin: Revenue minus direct costs, as a percentage.

Channel: How you reach customers.

Payback period: Time to recover acquisition cost.

8. Next Steps

Connect Entrepreneurship with Digital Marketing and AI for Business to scale acquisition and operations intelligently.

- Interview 5 customers before building.
- Track unit economics before scaling ads.
- Run weekly KPI reviews.